

narrow operating band or frequency. In a high population density country such as India, CDMA proves to be cheaper for operators in the long run.

Recent CDMA standards have started incorporating some of the advantages of GSM. One step in this direction was the introduction of the removable user identification module (RUIM), the CDMA equivalent of the SIM card. Not only does this allow the user to switch handsets easily; but, in some countries such as the US, it also allows the user to use CDMA phones on a GSM network with which the provider has a roaming agreement.

4.4 General packet radio services (GPRS)

Put simply, it is a modification to the GSM standard that allows one to access the internet whilst on the move. It allows for speeds as high as 114 kbps. The introduction of GPRS to the GSM standard allowed users to use the following applications:

Multimedia messaging service (MMS): an extension to the SMS service that allows transfer of pictures, video and audio as messages.

Push to talk (PTT): a feature that allows the user to use the phone like a two way radio, pressing a button to be immediately connected to a closed group of people.

WAP: abbreviation for wireless application protocol, this feature allows applications on the mobile phone to connect to the internet.

Email: runs on WAP.

With the introduction of GPRS, GSM is considered to have become a 2.5G standard.



Web browsing on GPRS